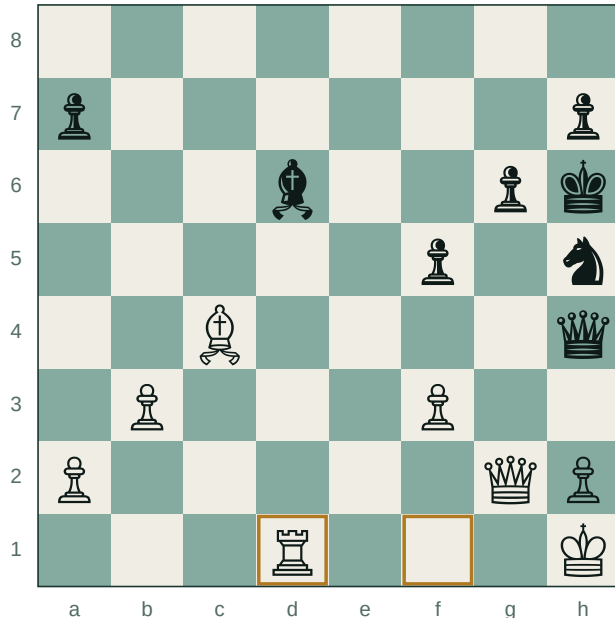


# Pins and pressure: Black, move 35

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 35.Rd1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

## 35...Ng3+ 36. Qxg3 Bxg3

**35...Ng3+** Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **36.Qxg3**.

**36...Bxg3** The bishop captures the queen on g3.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

### CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -2 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

### CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

### WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

### HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on h1. Absolute pin: pawn on h2.